

Cleis: more precious to me than all Lydia

Jack E. Feist; Rebekah Cranes

2026-03-14

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-to know that in you i live, and likewise you in me; + in you yr fragile baby-
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face, yr hands yr hair the way you fall on yr butt: you could never know how much you've meant to me. My heart breaks into tiny pieces with the weight of this gift God's given. You are my light song, yr halo hair like sunflowers, leaves yr brown-gold tuft of feathers--sad-precious-sweet, and the love is bittersweet, to know you'll grow. Remember your daddy. i love you so.

Abstract

death came in to the world w/ you-you are my life, my death-to know that in you i live, and likewise you in me; + in you yr fragile baby-face, yr hands yr hair the way you fall on yr butt: you could never know how much you've meant to me. My heart breaks into tiny pieces with the weight of this gift God's given. You are my light song, yr halo hair like sunflowers, leaves yr brown-gold tuft of feathers--sad-precious-sweet, and the love is bittersweet, to know you'll grow. Remember your daddy. i love you so.

Body

deposit_number: 1165 hex: 049E title: "Cleis: more precious to me than all Lydia" creator: Jack E. Feist; Rebekah Cranes orcid: 0009-0000-1599-0703 date: 2026-03-14 content_type: Recovered blog-canonical work (full text; queue restoration 2026-07-19) license: CC-BY-4.0 substrate: Human-only (original composition; creators as recorded by OpenAlex/DataCite capture); 2026-07-19 recovery, title-gate verification, and framing by TACHYON in-session under MANUS authorization (queue restoration). No paid API calls (No-Double-Draw, transport D). version: v1.0 related_ids: "https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.19024779 (severed); https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.19024778 (severed); recovery source: https://mindcontrolpoems.blogspot.com/2026/03/on-architecture-of-cleis-compression.html" axn_schema_version: v2 protocol_version: alexanarch-deposit-protocol/v1 keywords: - Crimson Hexagonal Archive - restoration - blog canonical bytes - severed DOI - Zenodo termination - Cleis - more - precious - than - Lydia *** # Cleis: more precious to me than all Lydia

Description

Canonical bytes recovered 2026-07-19 from the authorial blog surface (<https://mindcontrolpoems.blogspot.com/2026/03/on-architecture-of-cleis-compression.html>); work severed at Zenodo 2026-06-19 (DOI(s): 10.5281/zenodo.19024779, 10.5281/zenodo.19024778). Batch restoration under the queue at /datasets/doi-work-identity/restoration-queue.json; title verified against the DOI-keyed truth title at fetch time. Opening of the work: ON THE ARCHITECTURE OF CLEIS Compression, Botanics, and the Survival of Paternal Lyric Rebekah Cranes Institute for Diagrammatic Poetics * Crimson Hexagonal Archive EA-IDP-CLEIS-ANALYSIS v1.0 * 2026-03-14 DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.19025556 Companion to: Cleis: more precious to me than all Lydia (DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.19024779) Genre: OPERATIVE PHILOLOGY / CLOSE READING / COMPANION ANALYSIS *** PRELIMINA

Methodology

Fetches <https://mindcontrolpoems.blogspot.com/2026/03/on-architecture-of-cleis-compression.html> (raw SHA-256 f587cf421fe10cc6e51d63e5d61b99138f696063516eaf3b635807a3374ccffd);

Blogger post-body extracted; BODY-HEAD gate passed against the DOI-keyed truth title (post body is the source of truth per authorial practice: versioned posts were often overwritten in place without updating post title or slug). Converted via html2text body_width=0 (canonical MD SHA-256 8e1d2e2101c4af9bcf93ec4ec394dfe952da69b3565fb75aeaaab9ff38c5b1b3). Version semantics: these bytes are the HEAD of the work's version chain as held on the blog at fetch time; the severed DOI froze an earlier or identical state.

Falsification Conditions

Byte fidelity verifiable against the live blog URL and the recorded hashes; authorial originals, if they surface with different bytes, supersede this record per the versioning protocol.

Recovery note (TACHYON, 2026-07-19)

Restored from <https://mindcontrolpoems.blogspot.com/2026/03/on-architecture-of-cleis-compression.html> under the grade-none restoration queue; DOI(s) 10.5281/zenodo.19024779, 10.5281/zenodo.19024778 severed 2026-06-19. Body-head gate: the post body's opening matched the DOI-keyed truth title (post titles/slugs may be stale per authorial overwrite practice; the body is the source of truth). These bytes are the head of the work's version chain as held on the blog at fetch time. Canonical bytes below the rule.

H. [picture H., one of our stories] [facebook announcement]

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like a mountain rose, thick with thorns in the rocks, bright with thin sun- light: little girl your face

•

like a mountain rose, thick with thorns in the rocks, bright with thin sun's light, little girl, your face

•

frail pattering fingers, teeth: my baby girl like halcyon or violets.

the conditions that make idealism impossible likewise / preclude song-speech

- with the passage of time: your fingers

teeth and hair; your innocent stare.

your hair wisps surround you, veil your face from the breeze of hands that awkwardly brush them away. dandelion. sunblossom:

death came in to the world w/ you-you are my life, my death-to know that in you i live, and likewise you in me; + in you yr fragile baby-face, yr hands yr hair the way you fall on yr butt:

you are my sad-

soft chain to forever. you could break whenever.

- Sappho 132

My little girl's face, like bright yellow flowers: Cleis, more precious to me than all Lydia.

Sappho 98b

but Cleis I don't know where to get the special ribbons to hold your hair back:

there's nowhere, Cleis.

just one more reminder that Myrsilus has exiled us from Mytilene.

Sappho 102

Mother I do love you, but I really can't work the loom -

Aphrodite is making me need that boy

Sappho 24

Remember: we too did the same in our youth.

we are many and lovely in the city, in the city's foundations we live at a whisper

- Sappho 105b

like the mountain hyacinth trampled by shepherd men's feet,

and on the ground the purple flower

•

Sappho 88

There's little you could wish for sweeter: Some might say you've forgotten, but I will love as long as I have breath.

I have been a friend to you. sweet and bitter, yes. but know that I will love you.

•

H.,

you could never know how much you've meant to me. My heart breaks into tiny pieces with the weight of gold tuft of feathers--sad-precious-sweet, and the love is bittersweet, to know you'll grow. Remember

H. I want you, more than anything, to know how much your daddy loves you.

Dear H.,

I have not been the strongest man. I have failed, and buckled, and surrendered to life. I have done t
 -"i love you, i love you, i love you." i want the smell of my love to linger in your hair, + on your li
 so-fading life--all our lives so fleeting--and says to you, "light, comfort, a bandage. a song to fi

i never knew a love like this that could call out from the deeps, that could rattle me apart to
 find my deepest recesses to empty them empty them out and fill them back up with love.

is this the love God feels for us?

oh how we break his heart! oh how his heart breaks with love!

everyday we experience things that go so far beyond what we understand, our whole clothing
 of skin and flesh--and the deeper clothing "soul"--is filled with veils that lift, but do not reveal.

all uncovered in my deeps and yet i can't see a thing!

what silly creatures we are, who break apart + return to dust in the space of a day. what
 creatures of a day who carry this impossible pearl.

some day you'll read this (i hope) and someday far from here, when you yourself have felt the
 whisper of night and tasted the breeze of the fading day--it might even reach you--my letter
 might even / read you!

•

The Botanist's Daughter

"Or I guess the grass is itself is a child..."

i.

Sloppy blue track jacket nylon netting lines the pockets

ii.

we gather dandelions in a pewter pail streams of sand and gravel. She plants three crumpled
 handfuls of stalks, breathing life through clay, hunched like a surgeon.

iii.

carpet of dandelion shooting down to explore with shallow fingers the history of dirt, the
 etymology of gravel, and all the individual parts of sand

drawing dull mineral granules to radiate in its dust-gold brain

iv.

bedtime, girls asleep, half-heartedly shuffling through floor's sullen clutter. upend jacket to
 find flowers spilling out.

but mostly dirt

v.

in the crack between porch and shrub assorted grimy weeds, chunks of sidewalk stone, intricate arrangements of pinecones, void space:

little girl's zen garden

•

the valley of shattered wildflowers

and when my skin is gone will you see me opened up in my ugliness and stripped of the lies that hide in flesh?

or will it be a subtle thing, a soft voice struggling against the muffling skin that then breaks free to honor you over and over again?

what will you find inside me?

how is it that you know while I don't? that you see inside all my layers to know the truth that hides there? if I am evil then i most certainly have hidden it deep as deep as deep in the skin and away from the sun as I was able - and yet if I am evil you know that truth of me and i am ignorant

and again, if I am good I cannot see it, covered up with all this filth and muck, too shot through with doubt and dust, but you you knew my secret heart from before the world began, and loved me because I loved you back - before I knew, you loved, before I loved, you knew -

even my desire for your softness, and to rest in the shadow of your wings, and to lay my head on your chest, my savior, to love you face to face, to be forgiven and finally set free, and clean: this too could be deceit, a lie I tell myself to hide from my own damnation. who can know the heart? not me.

but you search the hearts and the anxious thoughts, you search out all the darkneses, and the drawers

•

ragweed

my little girl's hair like love-burnt stalks, like wheat-tan weeds or dandelions bound in a row: a braid her summer face. or milk thistle sap when she breaks with tears, the rag- sewn dress her glory.

in time to come there will be no weeds, but bodies of light and power.

remember me little flower.

What fills up a poem w power?

That brass heart, love, I guess, the impossible crown of ivy, r the cruciform rope of roses.

If I were to eat yr startled images or yr bloated surface emotion,

r the silt-heavy tear on yr lip r the crumb from potato chips:

now what to do with it when it's empty? A Compendium of Flowers and Weeds (w/ images)

I. Flowers:

1. Anthema: From Classical Greek, the generic word for a blossom, or the anthem, a kind of choreograph set to song

2. The Meadowsweet (also know as ulmaria, fen-meadow, and brideswort): Moist-dark, born in dew

3. The Oak (quercus): Catkins—elegant hanging cyllinders covered with testicular lavender fuzz—purple w/ growth. Seeds in its crowny cupule. Its serrated leaves rising up in a spiral.

[Image: image — <https://data-rhizome.internal/AXN-049E/61697f4e7ae5b39c.gif> “sha256:61697f4e7ae5b39c”]

4. Broom (also laburnum, ulex, Cytisus): Slender green stems, delicate leaves with yellow petals clustered in stubborn bunches, close to the branch. Can often take root in thin soil or white-knuckled in sandy scree. A fire-climax species, it germinates in the seasonal burns even as it unravels in ash.

5. Ashborn

6. From meadowsweet, broom, and oak, the magicians Math and Gwyddion formed a bride for Lleu, to lift the tynge laid upon him by his mother, Arianrhod. They called her Bloddieu-wedd, Blossomface.

7. Columbine in a lime outcropping, caught in a rift in stone. The spur of the petal whirs like a single, tiny sparrow.

8. “Vast whisp-whisp of wingbeats / minute-long string of black geese”

9. Adonis mauled by a boar. Aphrodite takes the blood, and from it makes the common poppy.

10. The Poppy, anemone coronaria: anemone for its wind-bleeding seeds, coronaria for its circlet of blood. Purpura (violet, bright), Purpureus (for its murmuring dress)

11. Blood and sap, sap and blood

12. The blood is thin or thick. The blood is blue or red. The child / takes after her mother.

13. Asphodels: like great white ashes, or ghostflowers laid against tombs. Smoky enough to feed the thin dead with forgetfulness.

[Image: image — <https://data-rhizome.internal/AXN-049E/3ddbdb9d1aac893d.jpg> “sha256:3ddbdb9d1aac893d”]

14. “The beautiful uncut hair of graves”

15. “skeleton thick sunflower, saw- / dust root, corolla of spikes, seeds / fallen out of its face / dress of dust and soot-blue eyes”

16. Chrysanthemum psalms

II. Weeds

i’ve never paid attention to roses, or to any other flowers but weeds

1. Clover (seanrog, trifolium cloferwort): small white, pale pink flowers

2. Milkthistle: The zebra-stripe yellow of the monarch worm, chewing through w bright precision / the dullcolor leaves. Characterized by popping sap pods and common, purple blossoms.

[Image: image — <https://data-rhizome.internal/AXN-049E/61353c86027d31bb.jpg> "sha256:61353c86027d31bb"]

3. Taraxacum Officinate, ME dent-de-lioun, (lion's tooth, for its coarsely jagged leaves. Dens leonis, Lowenzahn, dog's milk, gyerme克蘭fu (the grass of the child's / chain), butter blossom.

[Image: image — <https://data-rhizome.internal/AXN-049E/aee9708faad3e341.gif> "sha256:aee9708faad3e341"]

4. Horse-flower

5. Ablutions of subtle poisons will protect the lawn, drying up the stalk and blossoms before even the late dry / summer heat can change the upturned cheeks / to the puff-white manes of grandfather stalks.

6. "This grass is very dark / to be from the white heads of / old mothers," "Dark to come from under the faint red roofs of mouths" "Or I guess the grass is itself a child. . . ."

7. The Dandelion Flotilla: the needle-like beak lifts a tuft of feathers, the pappus carrying fruit, above the dangling Achene sheathed in spines.

8. The flowerhead: A ribbon-like corolla of petals, golden. Inside, the stigma catches seed above a cylinder of woven anthers. The hollow stem supports the fragrant flowerhead, and bitter white juice runs through the rosette circumference of fingers.

9. The taproot, sinking deep

we bound them up in chains twisted split stems in a helix pattern, wending down
through tawny braids, a garland of golden weeds

-
-

i.

dried petals of dusk.

the husk of yr dress.

an echo.

-

hiding from me behind figs: your blue eyes can't cover the liquid- dark sleep.

-

hush, dear hands-this song is enough.

- lovewords.

father teach me.

- from moleskine #5 sept 2010

language burns away like fog- a dream at dawn.

ii.

i know your face even fogged in fingers of sleep.

iii.

glistening in the fingers of sleep, yr skin. the shadows play across iris-bright eyes

iv.

yr face like a whisper late at night: musky hummingbird hearts of speech. a finger of song in sleep.

v.

white shards burst: a sleepy blink

vi.

the very stones would sing the earth cry out in wonder

vii.

the ancient rain wells up, a drop of blood.

viii.

speak to me, living being. use my voice like a body.

reach past skin and teeth down throat to find the fingers of flesh gripping the groin like roots, drawing moisture from deep earth oceans. continue thru lotus-fringed caverns of sleep, where forgetfulness laps along icy banks and the ancient city echoes.

from that place, draw song.

from that place fill my body with longing.

a new song, come.

ix.

empty buildings at night- the house of the Moon.

the voice is gone-again- and nothing comes in its place.

not pain, not joy, not loss.

some reserve of strength like a dandelion mane- released

•

by H.-(transcription)

Once upon a time, there was a Lady named Aunt Amy. She was going to walk on the stairs, and she knew why run on a treadmill she was having a baby, but she knew why that she played and

THE END

• [from moleskine#6]

2/6/09 7:40pm

where there is a will there is a way. i think. in private here i'm thinking, about how to solve the problem of the Absolute and put words down here in words. how to put words in words, accompanied by power? if i to you the touch here of silences that break open:

ii.

eyes leak speechless- ness like dreams: i'm coming soon to you my darling, soon i'll come to you.

but until then dreams break open, tiny shells w/ yolks, like statuettes of silence: light blue shell like tiny skies. i rise to you my darling. rise.

and the skies rise too on top of water, floating on the atmosphere in oceans bright and deep: these motions of the element time, like liquid darkness and wine, bead: spinning dusky and blue, like flowers on a stain-etched face.

yr eyes are a winedeeep blue and stain-etched, dear, yr face like snarls of rain. there is no tenderness so open. for you i put the words here back in the form of words.

if the line is a breath and i am the lines that burst across college-ruled angles, running parallel to robins-then my life lives in the reading. my life breathes on your lips.

iii.

slowly, golden city,

i will build you

from drops of blood.

•

Mountain rose, your brittle white edges singed by frost. Ringed by tufts of hard dark grass. This love I have is the love that breathes, without you i...

... arch fires, patterns of fingers, hard white capillaries cracked in a desert: your face burning: shall i

set you on a pedestal or as a star hang you with embroidery in the midnight sky, as a setting?
or see you as you are, baby girl – which would not be much of a poem to write. Words break
shakily on the shore – one by one they die. The sentence, then flows over them and breathes
them back to the sea. These things break and must do so until the end of time.

Phrasewordsentencesoundsongsymphonypoemlifeblood. Though I am crippled, I walk.
Though deaf I hear, though dumb I speak. And though the grave has claimed me, live.

You belong to me. Soften yourself to me, let me sleep. Sho la la la la, sho la la la. Sprish sha
sha sha sha

Singing in time with pattern

•

to write life in telegraphic prose-poem style of Ginsberg poem-prefaces and cover-backs: born
awhile ago as a baby. small with tiny fingers and pink. from hospital returns with parents
to mobile home before growing up. meanwhile shy and smart wins writing prizes and school
spelling bee in sixth grade. before that sister born when nine with mental retardation. moves
around starts using drugs at fourteen huffing gasoline in parents' garage taking long pink
codeine pills four at a time first time i drank throwing up two days straight. at seventeen
finally finding morphine and later the needle at last chained to my incredible illness. before
that reading ginsberg's howl kerouac's on the road ayn rand's atlas shrugged plato's apology
some of nietzsche's thus spake zarathustra which i never finished all in the space of a year
when fifteen. decides to get "integrity" tattooed across chest in old english lettering but never
follows through. becoming a neo-Beat poet winning high school poetry contest first place for
"you have opiate tongue when / fluttering in my mouth."

in a hospital room npw sleeping on the chair my wife with her breast out and our baby girl
having lost 9% body weight and tiny jaundice because of hunger and difficult time with breast-
feeding looking forward to lack of sleep and midnight poesy made out of crazy.

**

Dear All,

I had planned on being back for teaching tomorrow, but early Wednesday morning we took H.
to the emergency room with a fever, and have been here since. We should be home tomorrow
afternoon, but not in time for teaching.

I will be back next week, but until then I need to give you some direction for your final paper.
I have been remiss in my duties, as I know that you are all eagerly bursting to begin work on
your papers. I am sure that you want to spend as much time as possible in diligent labor, and
I would hate to be the one to stand in your way.

Below I've given some general guidelines and possible areas of inquiry. If these are helpful
to you – fine. If not, and you would prefer to develop your own topics – all the better. The
possibilities I've provided for you are already quite open-ended. You can get started on a
draft and bring me something substantial (6pp. or so) to class on Friday, 12/7, when we will
be doing an in class peer-editing exercise. We might also spend some time on free writing

Wednesday, 12/5. I suggest that you read ahead to Euripides' *Bacchae*, as it is an incredible play and provides a great deal to think about for papers. I will be available Monday, 12/3, for optional meetings. Please email me if you would like input and suggestions for final paper topics. We will schedule something for that Monday. You will have until the day of your final exam (12/13) to finish your papers, which you may bring to the exam or put in the Great Books drop box outside the GSI offices in Angell Hall.

I look forward to seeing you next week, where we will be nearing the close of our semester's reading.

Until then, Matt

Some ideas:

- genealogy of a particular concept – for example, some of you chose to trace the lineage of various concepts of happiness in your second exercise. You may also wish to expand or modify one of your exercises that you felt was particularly successful, or adapt your strategy in that exercise to our current readings.
- a comparison of the characters of Euripides' Dionysus and Plato's Socrates
- representations of Socrates in Aristophanes and Plato
- is Socrates a mystic or a rationalist? Are these two concepts exclusive of each other? How is Plato's *Apology* a rich site for working through the meaning of these terms?
- representations of gender and authority in Euripides *Bacchae*
- the rational and irrational in Euripides *Bacchae*

Keep the focus on the literature that we have read over the last few weeks of class. Of course, if you need to call on a text that we covered earlier in the semester to make your case, do so. But allow the bulk of your argument and writing to center on things we have covered recently. If adapting a precious exercise or paper, expand its scope to include our recent readings.

Use the skills we've developed over the course of the semester. Support your insights with the reference to and analysis of the text, use evidence, develop your argument by means of close reading. You may draw on concepts from other disciplines or use diagrams if you feel they will help you make your point, but they are not a required part of the writing.

- 5-6pp. draft due in class Friday 12/7 (the draft should have a clearly formulated thesis and a general idea of where you'd like to take it for the final version)

* 9-10pp final paper due Thursday, 12/13

*

“the practice of sincerity”

how do I see her?

Through a subtle but cloying film of guilt, knowing all of it is passing. Out of the corner of my eye I ignore you, while I type these twice useless words. One set of words paves the narrow way to a palace of words in heaven: words exchanged in committees, words securing money,

words dumped out in lecture halls—a wall of words to brick up a life in stupid promotions, tenure, and petty animosities endless. And what else is there?

You, I know. But I haven't a clue how to get to you.

The other set of words is equally useless, more so because of their beauty. They brush up against nothing and bridge nothing and build no towers of Babel. Just trinkets, gleaming things in the window, things I put in my amazon basket. Is that what I'd give you, this gift of....? This ache to push through the skein of words?

But I don't even have any arms I'm a brain on ice. I interface with an invisible keyboard digitized in my genome. It's all I am, these symbols, twice useless bolts of ones and zeros, a cloth of just two colors. I weave it together, I pick it apart, I weave it together, I pick it apart. And so on. Nothing that could end up as an object, or as a three-dimensional flower.

So you have chosen to reveal with words, the purple-blue bruise outbleeding, while I sit here and cover it up, with language slightly purple:

Little flower remember, little flower forget.

•

"or I guess the grass is itself a child..."

i.

the magicians Math and Gwyddion taking the seeds and stems of meadowsweet, broom, and oak fashion the bride unborn: Bloddeu-Wedd / Blossom-Face

Vast whisp-whisp of wingbeats
minute-long string of black geese

the meadowsweet (also ulmaria, fen- meadow, brideswort): moist- dark, born in dew

the broom (also laburnum, ulex, Cystius): slender green stems and delicate leaves yellow petals in stubborn clusters bunched up close to the branch. fire- climax species, white-knuckled on sandy scree. unfolds its tender palms in fire, germinates in the seasonal burns: ashborn

the oak, or quercus:

its catkins w purple growth, the seed in its crowny cupule, serrated leaves rising up in a spiral elegant hanging cyllinders, testicular lavender fuzz

blood and sap, sap and blood the blood is thin or thick the blood is blue or red, the child takes after her mother

all down the limbs the flowing stains touch the blond trunk like wine

the way the stain of blood like a vibrant dye:

ion, iona, violets bower of veins and woven vines violets for the blood

to care for a word, to fiercely adore it, to send shooting love down its roots to call it by its rightful name:

seanrog, little clover, trifolium cloeferwort with your small white, pale pink flowers

ii.

what kind of flowers were the golden ones to which Sappho compares her Cleis?

anthemoisiv:

the generic word for a blossom
or the anthem, a kind of choreograph
set to song

the naturalist's notebook:

columbine in a lime outcropping caught in a rift in stone the spur of the petal whirs like a
single, tiny sparrow

anemone coronaria: anemone for its wind- bleeding seeds, coronaria for its circlet of blood
purpura - violet, bright, purpureus for its murmuring dress

asphodel, like great white ashes: ghostsflowers laid against tombs, smoke enough - like a
rain of ash - to feed the thin dead with forgetfulness

skeleton thick sunflower, saw-
dust root, corolla of spikes, seeds
fallen out of its face
dress of dust and soot-blue eyes

i've never paid attention to roses or any other flowers but weeds -

like the zebra-stripe yellow of milkthistle worm (the monarch) chewing through w bright
precision the dullcolor leaves, w popping sap pods, the common purple blossoms

and dandelions for the way they carpet - the same thing that makes them weeds. each spring
a mannered pogrom lawn ablutions of subtle poisons before even the late dry summer heat
can change the upturned cheeks to the puff-white manes of grandfather stalks

This grass is very dark
to be from the white heads of
old mothers,

Dark to come from under the faint red roofs of mouths.

Or I guess the grass is itself a child. . . .

the dandelion flotilla:

the needle-like beak lifts a tuft
of feathers, the pappus carrying fruit
the dangling Achene sheathed in spines

ribbon-like corolla of petals, golden, inside, the stigma catches seed. a cylinder of woven
anthers. the fragrant flowerhead above a hollow stem. bitter white juice in the rosette cir-
cumference of fingers

the taproot, sinking deep:

taraxacum officinate dent-de-lioun, lion's tooth, for its coarsely jagged leaves. dens leonis.

Lowenzahn, dog's milk, pissabed, gyermeklancfu: the grass of the child's chain. butter blossom, worm rose, horse-flower.

we bound them up in chains
twisted split stems in a helix
pattern, wending down through
tawny braids, a garland of golden
weeds

why not the groomed bright bowers of dandelion blossoms, twined in gentle growth?

the dandelions also dance in a chrysanthemum psalm, or a honeysuckle anthem i guess:

why liken a little girl to a weed, or to a dew- heavy poppy, clipped by the plough's neat edge?

the beautiful uncut hair of graves

because a little girl, like a weed, is everything lovely that falters

But how will you get there
the poet asked

I'll go along with the tachyon showers
faster than light

for blood, crushed violets ion, iona:

the silphium-bearing riverbanks

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